

Bill Spencer

From: Adam Fyall
Sent: Wednesday, June 20, 2018 2:31 PM
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Subject: PILT 2018 Update & Path Forward

Hi everyone. As spring gives way to summer, I hope this message finds you well.

It has been a while since I have provided you a comprehensive update on Payments In Lieu of Taxes, and I apologize for that. I want to take an opportunity to do just that, and I have set-up a meeting time next week for that purpose. I understand it's not the longest lead time nor the best time of year, but in working with a some interested folks we just picked a time to go with it. If you or someone from your organization cannot attend next week in-person, I'm happy to try to meet with you elsewhere in-person, or get you information over the phone or via email.

Our meeting will be next **Wednesday, June 27, 1:00, at the Tri-Cities Business and Visitor Center in Kennewick**. This is the building where TRIDEC, Visit Tri-Cities, and the Tri-Cities Chamber of Commerce offices are co-located.

There will be two main topics for discussion:

- Status of 2018 PILT. Benton County has invoiced DOE-RL and have been notified that DOE *will not* have sufficient funds to remit payment in-full.
- Future of PILT. We need to start having some hard discussions about how we address our PILT situation going forward, because the message above in the first bullet is likely the message for the future. As I like to say it, PILT needs to be *durable, sustainable, and predictable*.

DOE PILT is now a national issue. We are not sure what that will mean for these payments and for local governments, but I think it would be best if we are out in front of things and try to lead toward possible solutions.

Benton County has an excellent, long-term relationship with TRIDEC, as does DOE. I have asked TRIDEC to play a role of facilitator in this process, and they are hosting this meeting next week. Should we proceed with discussions with DOE about how PILT might be adjusted or approached differently in the future, I would like TRIDEC to continue that role.

Thank you for your interest, and I hope to see many of you next week. Let me know if you have questions, comments, or need to make other arrangements.

Adam

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